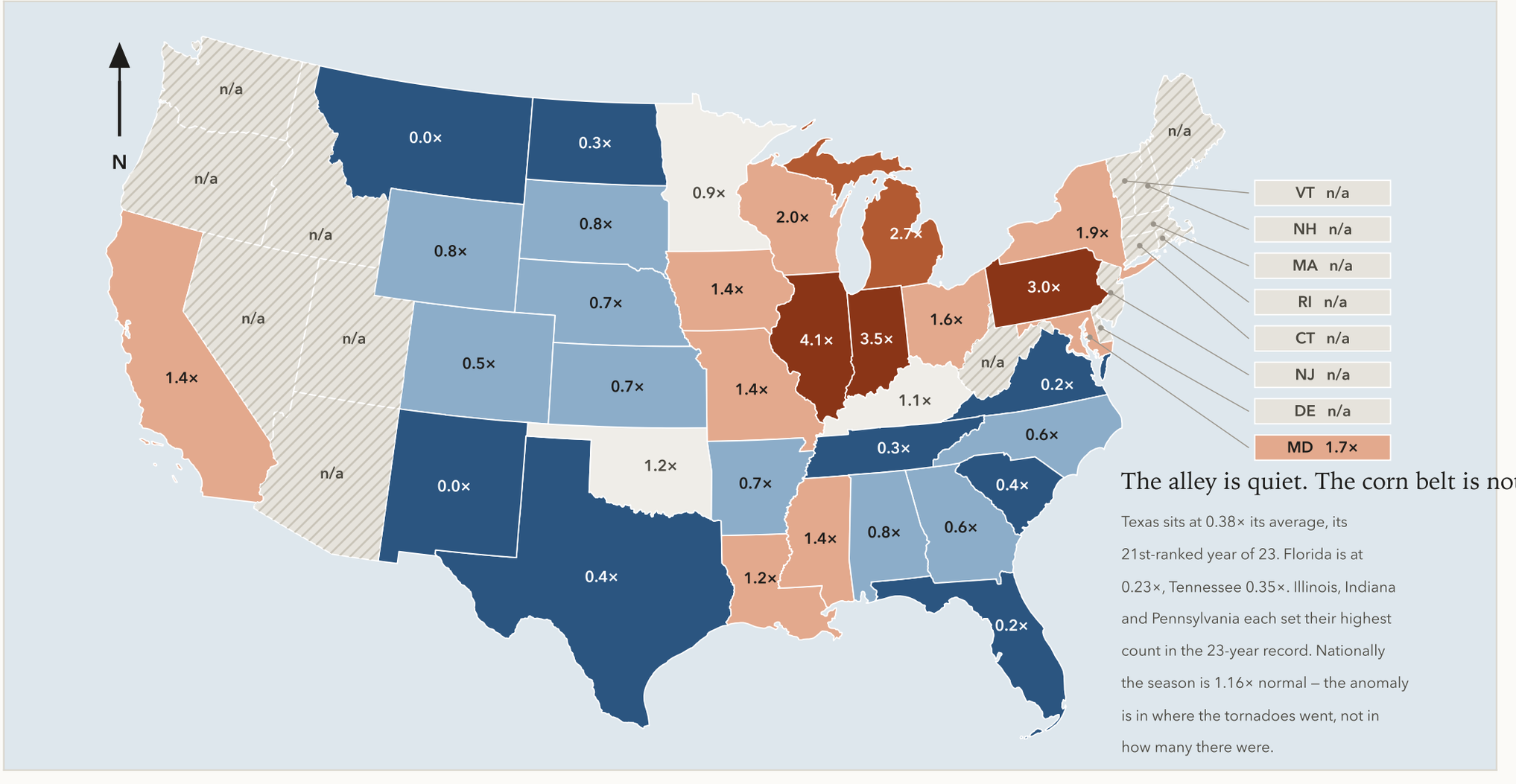
PLATE III

A displaced tornado season

2026 reports against the same state's 2004–2025 average for 1 January – 13 August · Illinois runs at four times its own normal



The alley is quiet. The corn belt is not.

Texas sits at 0.38× its average, its 21st-ranked year of 23. Florida is at 0.23×, Tennessee 0.35×. Illinois, Indiana and Pennsylvania each set their highest count in the 23-year record. Nationally the season is 1.16× normal — the anomaly is in where the tornadoes went, not in how many there were.

2026 against its own 2004–2025 average

below 0.5× · 0.5 – 0.8× · 0.8 – 1.25× near normal · 1.25 – 2.0× · 2.0 – 3.0× · 3.0× or more · base rate too low

Data Iowa Environmental Mesonet, IEM Autoplot #163, preliminary Local Storm Reports, type TORNADO, 2004–2026. Retrieved 22 August 2026.

Projection NAD83 / Conus Albers (EPSG:5070), equal area. Boundaries US Census Bureau cartographic boundary file, 2023, 1:20,000,000.

Method Each state is set against its own 2004–2025 mean for the identical window, so the map shows anomaly, not exposure. Classes are fixed multiples about a true midpoint of 1.0×; states averaging under five reports a year are masked. Plate by J. Kenny, 22